

Chapter 88-2

//

The night before joining the production crew, Liang Shi asked Xu Qingzhu to go out for dinner.

The location was set at a Western restaurant not far from their neighborhood.

Because there was a medical university nearby, many of the customers were college students—quite a few men and women alike.

The restaurant's popularity exceeded Liang Shi's expectations. This was already the best one she had found after checking reviews.

It perfectly met the System's requirements: cello accompaniment and aromatic red wine.

Liang Shi first pulled out a chair for Xu Qingzhu, then sat down across from her. When the server brought the menu, Liang Shi pointed at Xu Qingzhu. "Give it to her."

Xu Qingzhu didn't stand on ceremony either. She ordered skillfully, and Liang Shi simply said, "I'll have the same as her."

On the stage, the cellist wore a blue evening gown and elegantly drew the bow across the strings. The entire restaurant was enveloped in an atmosphere called "romance."

No one in the restaurant was being loud, but quite a few gazes fell upon the two of them.

This was probably because there were many students here, while one of them wore a casual-cut light-colored suit, and the other wore a dark suit jacket over a moon-white, low-cut, waist-hugging long dress.

Xu Qingzhu's long hair was let down. Before the food arrived, Liang Shi passed her the hair tie from her arm, but Xu Qingzhu shook her head. "Too lazy."

She said "lazy," not "I don't want to tie it up."

Liang Shi paused, then asked hesitantly, "Should I help you?"

Xu Qingzhu sat there, her slender back ramrod straight. Her voice was very soft, blending with the cello music—you couldn't hear it unless you listened carefully.

She said, "If you could."

Liang Shi smiled helplessly, thinking there was nothing she couldn't do.

It was a bit warm in the Western restaurant. She took off her suit jacket, leaving only the long dress underneath. Around her neck hung a blue necklace that resembled a sea of stars. Her brown wavy curls fell to one side, while the other side, with her ear exposed, sported blue tassel earrings that seemed to be from the same collection as her necklace.

Only after she removed her suit jacket did the bracelet on her wrist become visible. The ordinary silver bangle, not an outdated style, was worn by her with the quality of haute couture. Complementing the silver bangle was a blue bracelet.

Only the hair tie on her other arm was black.

Liang Shi's long dress was off-shoulder, with a layer of glitter powder on her collarbone that was particularly dazzling.

It was only after entering this restaurant that Xu Qingzhu carefully examined Liang Shi's outfit. She suddenly felt that her own professional attire was inadequate.

Liang Shi's ensemble could go straight to a red carpet event.

In this restaurant, it wasn't just Xu Qingzhu staring at her—quite a few people had their eyes fixed on Liang Shi.

Someone at the neighboring table even said, "That girl is so gorgeous."

"Hey... she looks familiar."

"Come on, every pretty girl looks familiar to you."

"No! I remember now—the one who trended last time!"

"Which one?"

"..."

After rummaging through their phone, they handed it over. "The lady in red from Qingyi University. She changed her clothes today, but she still slays me."

"If your girlfriend hears that, you're dead for real!"

"Which girlfriend are you talking about?"

"..."

The table not far away seemed to be friends who had come together, simply here to eat Western food. Two girls, and while chatting, their gazes never left Liang Shi.

As it happened, Xu Qingzhu had good hearing. Even mixed with the gentle cello music, every word of their conversation fell into Xu Qingzhu's ears without missing a single detail.

Xu Qingzhu had also seen that trending topic last time.

#Qingyi University Lady in Red#—which later spawned the hashtag #All the Beautiful People Enter the Entertainment Industry#.

Liang Shi's fan count had skyrocketed that day, and the "Mo Guang"¹ production crew had also gotten a wave of promotional buzz.

Xu Qingzhu had stared at the trending topic for quite a while. The comment section was full of: "Wifey, let me smooch²," "Big sis, let me smooch."

Looking at it made her feel...

She didn't know what she felt, but anyway, Xu Qingzhu drank a lot of water that day.

While those two were chatting, Liang Shi had already gotten up and walked over to Xu Qingzhu's side. All she could hear was the music.

The cellist's skill level was average—probably a part-time student from a nearby university's music department. It could only be described as passable, still a ways off from a professional cellist.

Liang Shi stood behind Xu Qingzhu, using her ten fingers like a comb to run through her hair.

Xu Qingzhu's hair hadn't been styled much and was very smooth. She had never dyed her hair, but her hair color wasn't deep black—it leaned more toward brown, which particularly complemented her skin tone.

Liang Shi left two strands by her ears and gathered the rest in her palm, wrapping the tie around three times. Then she tugged at the roots to leave some slack so it wouldn't pull on her scalp.

Footnotes:

¹ **Mo Guang (餘光)**: The title of the drama Liang Shi is filming. The Chinese title "餘光" literally means "peripheral vision" or "lingering light/afterglow."

² **Let me smooch (貼貼, tiē tiē)**: A popular Chinese internet slang term expressing affection, admiration, or the desire to be close to someone. Literally meaning "stick together" or "cuddle," it's commonly used by fans to express their love for celebrities or attractive people they admire.